

Guidelines for PhD Thesis in Monograph Format

Overview

The **PhD Thesis in Monograph Format** is the most traditional thesis style, where the thesis is written in the form of progressive narrative chapters that build on each other, either chronologically or thematically, to develop the main arguments of the thesis. This is the most flexible format, but the final thesis should read as a coherent whole.

Doctoral researchers can change thesis format at any time up to their submission for examination. If the thesis topic or research plan changes significantly at any point during enrolment, the thesis format should also be evaluated to ensure it remains appropriate. An alternative thesis format is *Publication Format*, please see the **Guidelines for PhD Thesis in Publication Format**.

The most important consideration when selecting a PhD thesis format is to decide which is most appropriate to the research topic and the specific programme of research required; all thesis formats are examined to the same standard. It is emphasised that a monograph thesis format does not preclude doctoral researchers from publishing their PhD research either during or following their enrolment or examination.

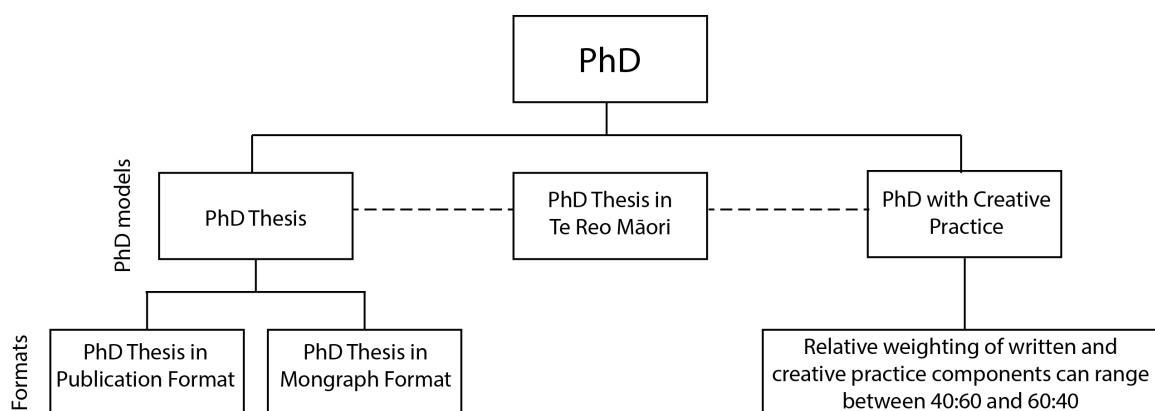


Figure 1: Summary of PhD models and formats available at the University of Waikato

Key Points

- Flexible format of narrative chapters that build on each other to develop a cohesive argument.
- The exact number of narrative chapters is not prescribed at a University level, but generally three or more would be expected to develop an argument appropriate for a doctoral-level contribution.
- The thesis format can be changed, for example from monograph to publication format, at any time. The final thesis format need only be declared formally at the point of submission.
- An alternative thesis format is the **PhD Thesis in Publication Format**

1. Requirements

The **PhD Thesis in Monograph Format** requires progressive narrative chapters that build on each other, either chronologically or thematically, to develop a cohesive argument that addresses a clearly defined research question or aim. This is the most flexible format but the final thesis should read as a coherent whole, advancing knowledge or practice on a specific topic.

The underpinning research must have been undertaken during the period of enrolment in the PhD. Work prepared prior to the period of enrolment is not eligible to be submitted for examination within any PhD thesis format at the University of Waikato. The Higher Research Degree regulations apply in full regardless of the thesis format or model.

2. Main body of the thesis

The submitted thesis must include the following chapters:

- An introduction outlining the overarching research question, hypothesis or aim, and introducing the structure of the thesis.
- A literature review that provides the contextual framework for the research and situates the thesis within the context of the published literature.
- A methodology chapter that outlines the research approach taken and/or theoretical framework selected, together with a clear rationale.
- A series of narrative chapters that contain original research and build progressively on each other to develop an argument.
- A concluding chapter that summarises the key outcomes and advances in knowledge or practice resulting from the thesis, critically evaluates the initial research question or hypothesis, and identifies opportunities for future work.

3. Formatting

The thesis should be presented in a consistent format, citation style, and typeface.

Formatting requirements are not defined at a University level but should consider:

- Clear, easily readable font (e.g., 11 point Arial or Times New Roman)
- Sufficient line spacing to aid readability (e.g. 1.5 line space)
- Continuous page numbering throughout

Supplementary information should be included together at the end of the thesis in Appendices and appropriately cross-referenced.

References should be included together in a single bibliography at the end of the thesis.

Figures and tables should be numbered consecutively throughout the thesis and cross-referenced as a single Table of Figures in the front matter.

4. Published work

If articles (e.g., journal articles, book chapters, conference papers) have been published during the period of enrolment, and a Publication Format thesis is not appropriate, then the ideas contained within that published work may be incorporated within a monograph thesis. However, in contrast to PhD in Publication Format, the publications should be re-worked into a narrative style consistent with the rest of the thesis. They may not be reproduced as the publisher-formatted version.

Concepts or ideas contained in published work by the doctoral researcher should be cited and referenced within the body of the thesis text accordingly, as is expected for referencing any published work.

Figures to be included from published work may require permission from the publisher (see section 6)

5. Examination

This document and further information about examining this thesis format will also be included in the Guidance for Examiners provided by SGR.

6. Open access and copyright

The final thesis will be made available open access (unless embargoed) in the University of Waikato's Research Repository, Research Commons, in alignment with open research principles.

It is the responsibility of the doctoral researcher to ensure that any third-party copyright obligations to reproduce material contained in the thesis have been met. The University Library can provide guidance.

Illustrative structure template

1. Title Page*
2. Abstract**
3. Preface and/or Acknowledgements
4. Table of Contents
5. Lists of tables, figures etc.
6. Glossary (optional)
7. Main text of the monograph thesis
8. Bibliography/Reference list
9. Appendices (if any)

* the date that appears on the title page should be the year in which the completed thesis is submitted.

**the abstract should be a succinct summary (no more than 350 words) of the aim, method, main finding(s) and conclusion of the research.